NCCP 00254 · VERSION 5

Anastrozole · daily hormone therapy

Take anastrozole once daily continuously. There is no planned week off. The treatment setting determines the intended duration.

Make treatment fit into daily life

Swallow the tablet whole with water, with or without food. Do not replace a missed or vomited dose; resume the next scheduled dose.

A continuous daily medicine

Choose a consistent daily routine. There is no chemotherapy-style rest week or automatic restart date.

Support joint symptoms

Discuss safe physical activity, strength work and symptom treatment. Report symptoms early so the team can consider support or a planned switch instead of you stopping without advice.

Keep the bone-health plan

Ask when the baseline DXA result will be reviewed and when the next assessment is due. Calcium, vitamin D and bone medicines depend on diet, deficiency and fracture risk.

If periods return

Tell the oncology team about bleeding or return of periods, particularly after chemotherapy or if menopause was uncertain. Do not assume ovarian suppression is part of this monotherapy card.

Who arranges each check?

Agree the due window, booking team, result reviewer and whom to contact if an appointment or result is missing. This reference page does not book or record a test.

Sources and review

The NCCP regimen supplies the treatment rules. Separate guidelines supply the longer-term monitoring recommendations, with their qualifications retained.

- NCCP 00254 v5 · official regimen
- HPRA Anastrozole SmPC cited by NCCP
- ATAC: ten-year analysis of anastrozole versus tamoxifen
- Pan-Asian adapted ESMO early breast cancer guidelines
- Pan-Asian adapted ESMO metastatic breast cancer guidelines
- NICE NG 101: early and locally advanced breast cancer
- ESO-ESMO ABC 5 consensus: tumour-marker interpretation
- IOF/CABS/ECTS/IEG/ESCEO/IMS/SIOG updated joint statement on aromatase-inhibitor-associated bone loss
- eviQ 3650 v 6: adjuvant whole-breast radiotherapy

Source reconciled; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending